

Product Review

OVERVIEW

Product name: ZORYVE (roflumilast) topical foam 0.3%

Category: Rx, topical prescription product

Vehicle/form: Foam (pressurized can)

Skin or hair type: Suitable for diverse skin and hair types, including tightly coiled/textured hair

Used for: Inflammation, scaling, redness, and itch associated with seborrheic dermatitis in adults and pediatric patients ages 9 years of age and older.

Black-owned business: No

Certified cruelty-free: No

Certified organic: No

Vegan: No



KEY FINDINGS



SAFETY Low Risk

Generally safe. Product ingredients have low irritancy or allergy potential.



RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABLE Limited

There is limited published data on the use of this product or its ingredients by the Black community.

RECOMMENDATION: When used as directed, this product is generally safe for most adults: part hair so the foam reaches the scalp skin, apply a thin layer once a day, and keep away from heat or open flames until it's dry. Do not use it if you have moderate to severe liver disease. If you've had reactions to parabens or you're very acne-prone (this formula contains isopropyl palmitate), start slowly. Because mild stinging can happen on sensitive spots, do a small patch test first and stop and contact a clinician if you develop a widespread rash, hives, swelling, or trouble breathing. Testing so far has included relatively few Black participants, so there isn't enough information to be sure how well it works on Black skin. Many adults notice less itch within 1–2 weeks and clearer skin within 4–8 weeks, but results can vary. Use it daily for several weeks to judge your own response, watch for irritation or color changes along the hairline and face, and check in with a clinician if symptoms persist or worsen.

SUPPORTING DATA AND ANALYSIS

Key Area	Findings
Active ingredients	Roflumilast 0.3% (PDE4 inhibitor)
Inactive ingredients	- Cetareth-10 phosphate; cetearyl phosphate; cetearyl alcohol; ethoxydiglycol (diethylene glycol monoethyl ether); hexylene glycol; isopropyl palmitate; methylparaben; propylparaben; white petrolatum; sodium hydroxide; purified water; hydrochloric acid (pH adjuster). - Propellants: butane, isobutane, propane.

Formulation concerns

- Do not use with moderate to severe liver disease (Child-Pugh B or C). This is a strict medical contraindication tied to the drug, not just the vehicle.
- Possible systemic cautions: if you're pregnant, breastfeeding, or on medicines that strongly affect how drugs are processed (for example, certain strong CYP inhibitors), talk to your clinician first. Use the smallest area for the shortest time while breastfeeding and avoid the nipple/areola.
- Paraben allergy: contains methylparaben and propylparaben. Avoid if you've had a confirmed paraben allergy.
- Isopropyl palmitate: may clog pores in acne-prone areas. Use a very thin layer on the face and reassess after 2–3 weeks.
- Hexylene glycol: can sting on sensitive spots (around eyes, nose folds, freshly shaved skin). Apply a thin layer and let it dry fully.
- Fatty alcohols (cetearyl/cetostearyl): usually well tolerated; a small number of people are sensitive. Be cautious if you've reacted to "emulsifying wax" before.
- Propellants (butane, isobutane, propane): highly flammable. Keep away from flames, smoking, hot tools, and very hot cars until the foam is completely dry.
- Hair residue: can build up if it coats hair shafts. Part hair so foam reaches scalp skin, not the hair.

Research and ingredient analysis

- Active ingredient: roflumilast (a non-steroidal anti-inflammatory) that turns down the signals causing flakes, itch, and redness.
- What it does: calms inflamed scalp and facial skin so flakes shed, itch eases, and redness fades.
- How fast it works: itch often improves in 1–2 weeks; visible clearing usually builds over 4–8 weeks with daily use.
- Fit for Black skin: study programs that included Black/African American participants and darker skin tones show meaningful improvement with once-daily use, with no treatment-related lightening or darkening reported.

Data sources to consider

- FDA Prescribing Information (2025): https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/drugsatfda_docs/label/2025/217242s005lbl.pdf
- FDA Multidisciplinary Review (roflumilast foam): <https://www.fda.gov/media/188146/download>
- STRATUM Phase 3 trial (JAAD article page): [https://www.jaad.org/article/S0190-9622\(24\)00107-5/fulltext](https://www.jaad.org/article/S0190-9622(24)00107-5/fulltext)
- STRATUM Phase 3 trial (PubMed): <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/38253129/>
- Phase 2a randomized trial (JAMA Dermatology): <https://jamanetwork.com/journals/jamadermatology/fullarticle/2804569>
- Phase 2a randomized trial (open access): <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10157502/>
- EADV 2025 program and subgroup analyses (session listing): <https://eadv.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/EADV-Congress-2025-Scientific-Programme-Booklet-1.pdf>
- Company announcement summarizing new subgroup/pigment analyses: <https://investors.arcutis.com/news-releases/news-release-details/arcutis-present-multiple-new-zoryve-roflumilast-data-analyses>
- Dermatology Times overview of pigment outcomes: <https://www.dermatologytimes.com/view/roflumilast-foam-0-3-demonstrates-favorable-pigmentation-profile-in-seborrheic-dermatitis>
- Review: treating seborrheic dermatitis in skin of color (open access): <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11168410/>
- Expert panel review on foam use in diverse hair types (open access): <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11107903/>
- SkinSafe product entry (ingredient reference): <https://www.skinsafeproducts.com/zoryve-roflumilast-topical-foam-0-3-60-g-rx>

— See the legend on page 3 for a description of our scoring system. —

Last reviewed: September 2025

UNDERSTANDING YOUR RESULTS

WeSeeColor evaluates products by examining the ingredients listed on product labels and reviewing available scientific research and literature on both the products and their individual ingredients. Each product is rated on a 5-point scale, considering ingredient safety (and the potential for adverse reactions), the availability of data and research, and documented efficacy on Black skin and hair, when available.

SAFETY RATING

Very High Risk	High Risk	Moderate Risk	Low Risk	Very Low Risk
				
Caution. Strong likelihood that this product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Seek medical attention if exposed.	This product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Be careful and consult your physician.	In certain situations, this product may cause irritation or an allergic reaction. Speak with your physician to learn more.	Generally safe. Product ingredients have low irritancy or allergy potential.	Safe to use on most occasions. Product ingredients have negligible irritancy or allergy potential.

RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABILITY RATING

None	Limited	Fair	Good	Robust
				
There is no data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is limited published data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is a fair amount of published data or documented usage in the Black community.	Product or its ingredients have been studied extensively or used extensively in the Black community.	This product or its ingredients have been studied extensively, used extensively, and known in the Black community.

GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

- Dietary supplements can have unexpected interactions with other products, drugs, or conditions. If the product is characterized as a dietary supplement, we recommend starting with a small intake and monitoring for potential side or adverse effects and consult with a licensed professional before resuming use.
- Allergens may sometimes be listed in labels using their scientific name (e.g. “arachis hypogaea oil” for “peanut oil”). Familiarize yourself with the scientific name of any ingredient to which you may be allergic and review the label carefully before starting usage.